

EXAMINED

Remax RB-520HB Wireless Headphones

Hong Kong-based WK Life, has brought out an affordable pair of wireless headphones that doesn't compromise on design. The headphones feature a stainless steel head beam, leather earmuffs and an overall metallic finish. We got the Gold variant here at the labs. The headband has leather-cushioning and is adjustable. The earcups rotate 90 degrees for easy storage as well. Despite the impressive design, comfort was really an issue for us. The clamping force is a bit too much which causes significant discomfort to the ears and causes them to get hot within half an hour of wearing them. The headphones have the standard power button, volume controls and micro-USB charging port placed on the right earcup, while the left one features a 3.5mm jack, in case the battery dies and you still want to continue listening. When it comes to



performance, the REMAX headphones perform as well as you can expect budget Bluetooth headphones to perform. The bass is strong and thumpy, and the volume can get pretty loud as well. However, the soundstage isn't as good as you'd expect and the vocals and instruments can sometimes sound muffled. REMAX claims that the headphones have noise cancellation technology embedded in them as well, however, they seemed to still let in some ambient noise. The battery life is about 5-6 hours and the headphones take about 3.5 hours to charge completely. Overall, these aren't the best sounding budget Bluetooth headphones out there.

PRICE: ₹3,999

LaCie Portable SSD

The LaCie Portable SSD is a lightweight and easily pocketable SSD at only 82g and a thickness of around 9mm. The SSD has a charcoal black finish and features an aesthetically-pleasing copper-red rim accent. The company claims that the SSD is drop-resistant upto a distance of 2 meters. It comes in three storage capacity variants - 500GB, 1TB and 2TB. When it comes to performance, the LaCie Portable SSD is advertised to have an average speed of 540MB/s. We got write speeds of approximately 500MB/s and read speeds of roughly 560MB/s, but this was after bumping up the number of threads accessing the drive to eight. The SSD is shipped with two cables - a USB-C to USB-C cable and a USB-C to USB-A cable. You also get a three-year warranty as well as a three-year Seagate Rescue Data Recovery Plan with the SSD.



PRICE: ₹14,000 (500GB MODEL)

Carvaan 2.0

After the colossal success of the original Carvaan, which released back in 2017, Saregama has now unveiled the second instalment, Carvaan 2.0. It comes in two colour variants - Classic Black and Emerald Green. You also have the Champagne Gold and Rose Gold variants of the Carvaan 2.0 featuring Harman Kardon speakers, but they are significantly more expensive. The retro feel and look is still very much present in the Carvaan 2.0 and it even comes with an antenna! While most features remain unchanged from its predecessor, which also includes sound quality, their newest offering, Carvaan 2.0 now has the ability to allow users to access podcasts and



audio stations via Wi-Fi. The device also comes with 5,000 preloaded retro songs which are immensely popular with their target audience (ages 35 and above). The Carvaan 2.0 has four buttons - Artists, Specials, Geetmala and the newly added 'Wi-Fi' button. The connection to the Wi-Fi needs to be done only once, via the Saregama Carvaan app, and then the device reconnects to WiFi each time it is turned on. The app can also be used to search for specific podcasts and songs to play. We liked that the company have decided to include a remote control in the box this time around, unlike the first Carvaan. The battery life is pretty decent and allows approximately 5 hours of audio playback. Charging is done via a micro-USB charger and it usually takes about 2 and a half hours to be powered completely. Overall, Carvaan 2.0 isn't a significant upgrade, but we suspect that it will continue to retain its status as a great gifting option in India, especially for older individuals.

PRICE: ₹7,990